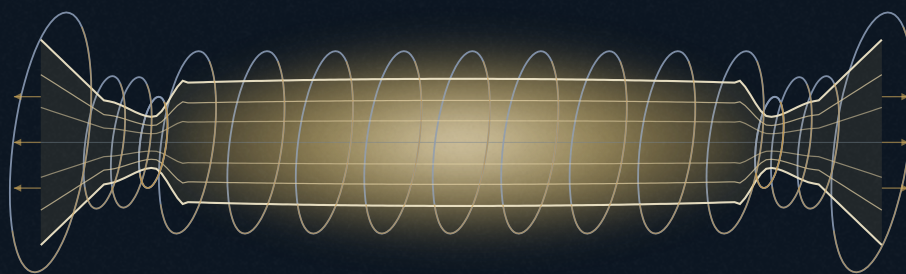




KRONOS FUSION ENERGY



PAPER 2.33 OF THE 2026 KRONOS SET

Thermal-Barrier Decoupling

The Cornerstone Plug Mechanism

The thermal barrier lets the plug hold a big potential without a hot central cell
— the lever that lifts Q_E .

ϕ_i 248.75→167.9 keV (33% gate cut) · Q_E 1.3→3-5

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THE OFFICIAL RECORD

What this document is, and how to read its numbers

This is a combined editorial. It gathers, in one volume, the two design studies Kronos Fusion Energy released in 2026 — a compact spherical-tokamak tritium/helium-3 breeder and a deuterium–helium-3 tandem-mirror generator — together with the intellectual-property estate, the people, and, in the internal edition, the full commercial case. The scientific text is the same text that appears in the arXiv preprints and the journal submissions; the editorial adds the apparatus a reader needs to hold the whole program at once, and nothing in the physics is altered to fit it.

THE HONESTY STANCE IS THE ASSET

Every headline quantity carries an **evidence class** — DERIVED RECOMPUTED MEASURED REQUIREMENT — and, where a number is a modelled extrapolation rather than a demonstrated value, it is labelled as such and its downside is shown next to it. Several quantities in the underlying corpus moved after first publication; where a value has been withdrawn or restated, the record says so plainly. This is deliberate: a diligence team will find the load-bearing assumptions, so the document surfaces them first.

TITLE	The Kronos Fleet — Hyperion · Aegis · MetroVolt: A Combined Design & Commercialization Study
AUTHOR	Priyanca Ford, Founder & CEO, on behalf of Kronos Fusion Energy
EDITION	2026 Combined Editorial · first issue
COMPANION WORKS	The five-paper arXiv drop — (1) Breeder, (2) Burner, (3) REBCO magnet & tape, (4) Direct Energy Conversion, (5) AI/ML/Quantum control — with matching numbered Zenodo deposits, plus the IOP journal and IAEA-FEC submissions. Patents were filed before the drop.
NAMING	Hyperion = the breeder; Aegis (defense) and MetroVolt (data-center) = one generator in two housings. Internal mode letters (D1, L) do not appear on public surfaces.
STATUS	Conceptual design & simulation study. Nothing herein is a construction commitment.



HOW TO READ THIS VOLUME

The fleet at a glance, and the way its numbers are marked

This volume opens with *Orientation*, presents the five research papers as a bound sequence, and closes with the *Apparatus*. *Foundations* sets out the three general results both machines rest on. *Paper One* is the Hyperion breeder; *Paper Two* the Aegis / MetroVolt generator; *Papers Three, Four and Five* are the enabling science — high-field REBCO magnets and tape, direct energy conversion, and the AI / ML / quantum control stack. A *Digital Twin & 3-D Model* part follows, then the *Environmental* profile. The *Economics* and levelized cost and the *Business Case* and diligence record appear in the internal edition only; the *Simulations* proof record and the Apparatus — patent portfolio, team, limitations, and sources — close both editions.

THE FLEET AT A GLANCE

	HYPERION	AEGIS	METROVOLT
Role	Strategic-isotope foundry	Defense installation power	Campus power
Machine	Spherical tokamak	Tandem mirror	Tandem mirror
Fuel	Deuterium–tritium	Deuterium–helium-3	Deuterium–helium-3
Delivers	Tritium · ³ He · 14 MeV n	Resilient installation power	Firm campus power
Physics bar	Fusion gain only	Closure (gates named)	Closure + lunar ³ He
In the fleet	Breeds the fuel	Proves the generator	Commercial destination

HOW THE NUMBERS ARE MARKED

Every headline quantity carries an evidence class — **DERIVED** from first principles, **RECOMPUTED** from raw data, **MEASURED** in hardware, or a **REQUIREMENT** yet to be met. Financial figures carry a case label and are confined to the internal (confidential) edition. Values that moved after first publication are shown as withdrawn or restated rather than quietly changed. A capability you can evaluate is one whose limits are on the page.

ABSTRACT

Thermal-Barrier Decoupling — The Cornerstone Plug Mechanism

The plug's electrostatic potential is the burner's binding gate. A thermal barrier — a local density/potential depression sustained by ECH hot electrons and sloshing ions — decouples the plug potential from the central-cell electrons: the ion-confining-potential requirement drops from 248.75 keV to 167.9 keV (a 33% gate cut), hot-electron heating removes ~1093 MW of central-cell ECH, and in the aggressive limit Q_E rises from ~1.3 toward 3–5.

Companion deposit (code & data, reproducible under CC BY 4.0): DOI [10.5281/zenodo.22132209](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22132209) · Zenodo community *kronos_fusion_energy*.

Explore it live: [interactive 3-D model](#) · [run the physics validator](#) · [companion film series](#) (the deposited solvers, in the browser).

Keywords: [tandem mirror](#) [thermal barrier](#) [sloshing ions](#) [plug potential](#)

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NOMENCLATURE

Symbols, units, and the names of things

Q	plasma (fusion) gain, $P_{\text{fus}}/P_{\text{aux}}$
Q_E	engineering gain, net electric out / recirculating in
H_{98}	confinement enhancement over the IPB98(y,2) scaling
Z_{eff}	effective ion charge
c_{ee}	electron–electron bremsstrahlung leading coefficient, 2.120022 (exact)
τ_E	energy confinement time
I_p	plasma current
R_0, a	major radius, minor radius
κ, δ	elongation, triangularity
β_N	normalized plasma beta (Troyon-normalized)
TBR	tritium breeding ratio
DEC	direct energy conversion
CF	plant capacity factor (availability)
$FOAK/NOAK/BOAK$	first / n th / best of a kind
<i>Hyperion</i>	the ST breeder (internal: Mode D2)
<i>Aegis</i>	the generator, defense/installation housing (internal: Mode M)
<i>MetroVolt</i>	the generator, data-center housing (Mode M)

Breaking the coupling

A tandem mirror plugs its central cell with a potential, and the hotter the central-cell electrons, the more potential (and power) the plug must supply. The thermal barrier breaks this coupling — letting the plug hold a large ion-confining potential while keeping the central-cell electrons cool.

THE GATE CUT

Booking the barrier, the confining-potential requirement falls from 248.75 to 167.9 keV — a 33% cut in the binding gate. Heating the barrier hot electrons rather than the whole central cell removes ~1093 MW of ECH, and in the aggressive limit lifts Q_E from ~1.3 toward 3–5.

ECH thermal-barrier decoupling lifts Q_E (33% gate cut)

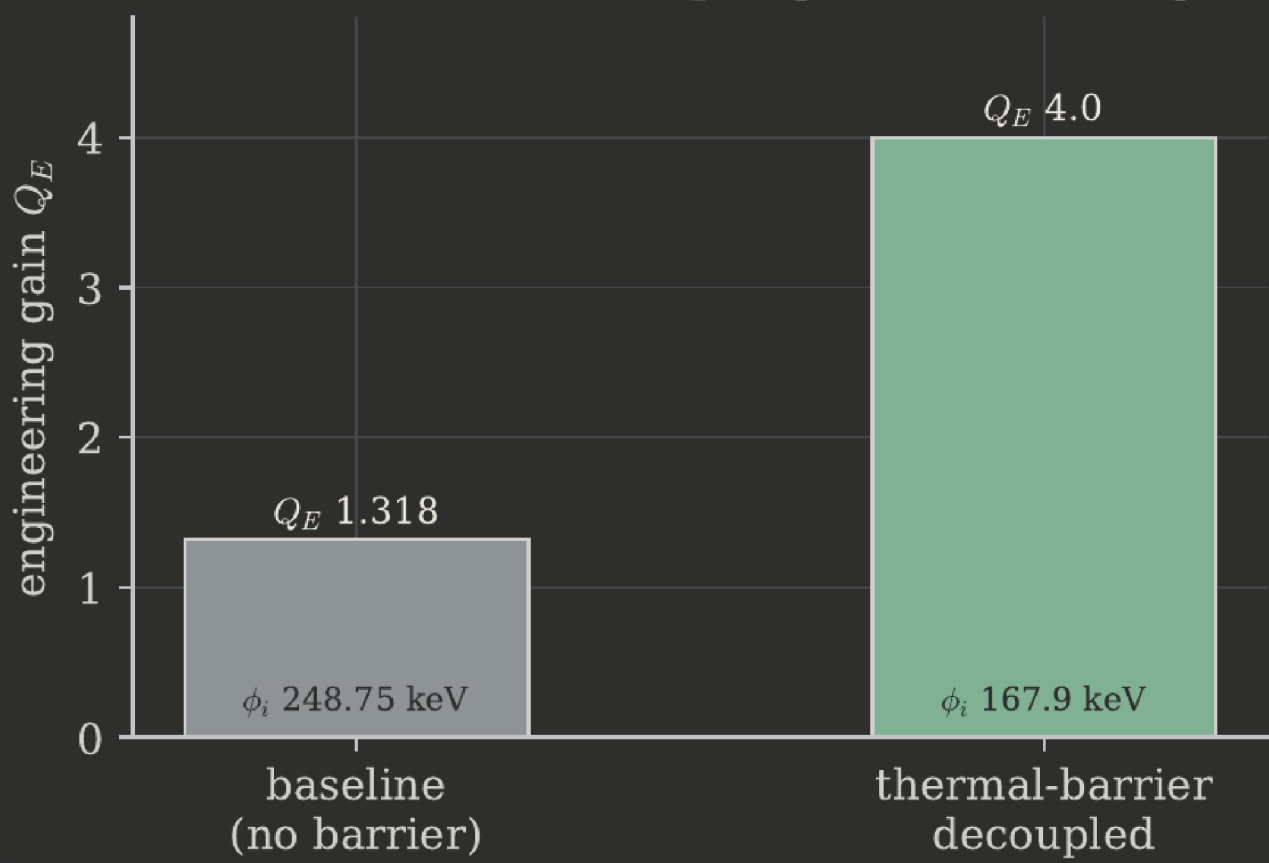


FIGURE 1. Thermal-barrier decoupling lifts Q_E and cuts the confining-potential requirement 33% (gate KX-L1-A13-BU). MODEL

§ 2

One named experiment

The barrier is the burner's cornerstone claim, and its distance to demonstrated closure is a single WHAM-scale thermal-barrier experiment that establishes the sustained depression and the decoupling at accessible field and density — a plasma-physics experiment, not a materials or magnet gate. **CORNERSTONE CLAIM**

A P P A R A T U S

Portfolio, People & Record

*The intellectual-property estate, the people who built it, the limitations
that gate it, and the sources it rests on.*

1

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INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

The patent portfolio

The estate spans a granted high-field magnet patent, pending utility and 2026 provisional filings that map to the two products, a digital-twin control provisional, a registered trademark application, and the original 2022 provisional family. Every patentable disclosure in the five-paper arXiv drop was protected **before** publication: the breeder and burner provisionals were filed 1–2 August, and a publication-gap omnibus filing the evening before the drop swept up the DEC, plasma-control, and REBCO-winding matter of the three otherwise-unprotected papers. Patent numbers and application serials are matters of public record; claim scope is summarised, not reproduced.

GRANTED & PENDING UTILITY

US 12,009,112	High-field tilted graded-REBCO magnet architecture (KRONO-002A) · app. 17/878,550	GRANTED
US 17/878,507	Core device / method (KRONO-001A) · utility	PENDING

2026 PROVISIONAL FILINGS — MAPPED TO THE PRODUCTS

64/124,209	Hyperion — spherical-tokamak tritium / helium-3 foundry · breeder · filed Aug 2026	FILED
64/124,220	Aegis / MetroVolt — synchrotron-cutoff, fuel-selection & plug-winding · generator · filed Aug 2026	FILED
64/115,167	KRONOS-CTRL digital-twin plant control · provisional · filed Jul 2026	FILED
64/005,440	Integrated spherical-tokamak fusion architecture · early integrated-architecture filing · filed Mar 2026	FILED
64/105,530	Negative-triangularity spherical-tokamak architecture · foundational ST filing · filed Jul 2026	FILED
64/128,097	Publication-gap omnibus — quasineutral two-species expander DEC · provenance-gated / latency-split plasma control · as-built high-field winding & conductor architecture · filed 7 Aug 2026, the evening before the arXiv drop	FILED

TRADEMARK & ORIGIN

FTK-98801894	Kronos Fusion Energy — trademark application	FILED
KR-2022-★	Original provisional family (KR-2022-00001 ... 00027) · 27 filings, 2022	PRIORITY

The narrow, defensible magnet novelty — the specific conductor and the digital-twin winding optimisation, not high-field REBCO as a category — is the commercial core that can earn ahead of any $Q > 1$ milestone, with markets in fusion magnet supply, MRI/NMR, accelerators, and proton therapy. The claim is scoped honestly: the high field is a *system field* result, not a stand-alone-coil record; the small-bore plug coil is structurally infeasible as a bare winding but resolved by a stress-managed structural shield (feasible-pending-FEA); and the winding-tape experiment returned a *null result*. The value is the method, not a field record.

THE TEAM

Founding partners, board, advisors & auditors

Kronos is built by a bench of advanced-fuel-fusion, high-field-magnet, direct-conversion, and materials specialists, with a board and operations team drawn from defense, national laboratories, and industry. Dates are shown as ranges; where a tenure has ended or is term-ending, the range says so.

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COLOPHON

How this document was made

The Kronos Fleet — Combined Editorial, 2026 is set in **Fraunces** (display), **Gelasio** (text), and **IBM Plex Mono** (data & equations), carried forward from the Kronos editorial design system.

The figures are rendered at 300 dpi from the deposited generator scripts; the document is composed as a single self-contained file with embedded fonts and imagery, paginated to US Letter, and rendered to PDF through a headless Chromium engine in matched light and dark editions.

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Numbers and their classes. Quantities are reported with evidence classes and case labels; modelled, assumed, and requirement-class values are identified as such and are not to be quoted without their labels.

Public edition. This edition carries the physics and design only; all financial, funding, and defense-commercial content has been removed for public distribution. The scientific text corresponds to the arXiv and journal submissions.

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THE 2026 KRONOS SET

One programme, in five papers

This editorial is one of five that together describe the Kronos fusion programme — a breeder that funds a generator, and the magnet, conversion, and control science that enable both. Each is published open-access with a reproducible companion deposit.

PAPER I	Hyperion — The Tritium Foundry · 10.5281/zenodo.21746157
PAPER II	Aegis & MetroVolt — The Generator · 10.5281/zenodo.21746479
PAPER III	High-Field REBCO Magnets & Tape · 10.5281/zenodo.21842514
PAPER IV	Direct Energy Conversion · 10.5281/zenodo.21842864
PAPER V	AI, ML & Quantum Control · 10.5281/zenodo.21842371

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[Zenodo · DOI 10.5281/zenodo.22132209](https://zenodo.org/doi/10.5281/zenodo.22132209)